**PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS**
**DIVISION OF INSTRUCTION & SCHOOL COMMUNITIES**
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**Date:** January 27, 2026
**To:** School Board
**From:** Dr. Isaac Cardona, Chief of Schools
**Subject**: 2026-27 School District Calendar

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Staff is submitting this recommended 2026-27 School District Calendar for the Board to consider and vote on at the February 10, 2026 Board meeting.

The proposed calendar includes the following agreements that align with the Portland Association of Teachers (PAT) Collective Bargaining Agreement:

- 193 contract days
- 176 instructional days, which include 3 conference days
- Eight early release days for PK, K-5, K-8, K-12 and middle schools for staff learning
- 10, 60 minute staff learning times for K-5, K-8, K-12 and middle schools throughout the year
- 30, 90 minute staff learning/meetings for high schools throughout the year

For the 2026-27 school year, one CSI/TSI day has been added on August 19, 2026 to support the ODE-designated schools and schools exited within the last 2 years and provide them with the opportunity for professional development and learning. Additional professional development days are contingent on budget decisions. Should funds be allocated during the budget process, professional educators from schools identified for improvement (CSI and TSI schools) would be required to attend. These are additional days added to the calendar and do not reduce the existing instructional days.

Feedback was received from building administrators, the Portland Association of Teachers (PAT), and the Portland Federation of School Professionals (PFSP).

The recommended calendar for the 2026-27 school year includes the following:

- Maintains the start of the school year before Labor Day
- Attempts to preserve or maximize uninterrupted whole weeks for instruction; no scheduled classes are proposed during Thanksgiving week to support family childcare planning and permit parent-teacher conferences to take place
- Aims to balance instructional days by quarter and semester: Q1 = 44 days, Q2 = 43 (this does not include conference days), Q3 = 45 days and Q4 = 41 days
- Aligns with the requirements in the various bargaining units' contracts
- Coordinates spring break with local university calendars, to align with schedules of older siblings and university student interns who work in our classrooms; Oregon spring break is traditionally the last full 5-day work week in March
- Ensures instructional hours for all students meet state requirements

- Attempts to maximize instructional days before Advanced Placement, International Baccalaureate, and other end-of-year summative assessments take place

- Avoids conflicts with major religious and cultural holidays to the extent possible
    - District practice has been to communicate to building administrators in multiple ways to avoid scheduling special school events on dates of major religious and cultural holidays

- A 3-day “Kindergarten Ramp Up” which will allow Kindergarten families to connect 1:1 with their teachers and Kindergarten students to practice school routines. Kindergarten students would begin their first full week of school on Monday, August 31, 2026

- To align with the PK agreement with PAT, PK will start on September 3, 2026, this will meet with the provision of designating 10 days before the first instructional day: 2.5 PD days, 1.5 set up/planning days, and 6 No Child Days (for home visits, etc).

- A 1-day Ramp Up for 6th, 9th, and 12th graders at comprehensive middle and high schools to support the transition for students to a new building for 6th and 9th graders and to kick off the final year for seniors

The proposed calendar includes three days for parent-teacher conferences. As in the 2025-26 school year, and in alignment with the PAT collective bargaining agreement, these days are counted toward the total required instructional days.

Staff recommends adopting this proposed calendar now so that staff and families may plan for the upcoming year.